

A Single Drop

A young boy was sent by his family to study the way of the Zen in a **monastery**. It was run by a **renowned** Zen master, Gisan. Much of the boy's days were spent in prayers and learning the **sutras**. Other times, he was on the rice fields or doing **chores** around the temple.



One day, Gisan asked the boy to heat water for his bath. The boy did not realize it, but the water began boiling and it became too hot to be handled. Gisan **instructed** him to **fetch** cold water from the well behind the monastery to cool the water.

The boy **lugged** two buckets of water and began pouring it into the bath. One bucketful was not enough. As he **poured** the second one, Gisan **dipped** his finger in the bath to check its temperature. When he felt it was just right, Gisan asked the boy to stop.

There was still some water left in the bucket. Without a second thought, the boy threw out the remaining water on the ground.

"What have you done, you fool? **snapped** Gisan. "Could you not have poured the water on that tree or on the flower bed? You should not have wasted that water."

The boy's eyes **brimmed** with tears as the **venerable** teacher continued, "Child, there is no rain at this time of the year and water is not easy to **come by**. Even a single drop of water is **precious**."

At that moment, the boy gained a new understanding of Zen. He adopted the name Tekisui, which means 'a single drop of water' and grew up to become a famous Zen teacher himself.

Vocabulary

1. **Monastery** (noun) – abbey, cloister, priory, convent, religious house मठ / आश्रम
2. **Renowned** (adjective) – famous, celebrated, eminent, well-known, acclaimed प्रसिद्ध
3. **Sutra** (noun) – scripture, teaching, doctrine, sacred text सूत्र / धार्मिक ग्रंथ
4. **Chore** (noun) – task, duty, job, errand, assignment काम / घरेलू कार्य
5. **Instruct** (verb) – direct, command, order, teach, advise निर्देश देना / सिखाना
6. **Fetch** (verb) – bring, retrieve, get, collect, obtain लाना
7. **Lug** (verb) – carry, haul, drag, tote, transport खींचकर/ढोकर ले जाना
8. **Pour** (verb) – tip, spill, stream, dispense, flow डालना / उड़ेलना
9. **Dip** (verb) – immerse, submerge, plunge, dunk, sink डुबोना / हल्के से डालना
10. **Snap** (verb) – shout, retort, bark, yell, rebuke झिड़कना / गुस्से में कहना
11. **Brim** (with) (verb) – overflow, fill, be full of, teem, burst भर जाना / लबालब होना
12. **Venerable** (adjective) – respected, honored, esteemed, revered, distinguished सम्मानित / पूजनीय
13. **Come by** (phrasal verb) – obtain, acquire, find, get, secure पाना / हासिल करना
14. **Precious** (adjective) – valuable, priceless, cherished, treasured, dear कीमती / अनमोल



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